

Figure 2.8 *Ghor Province, Alana Valley (junction of routes to Khissar, Parchaman, Nili, and Tiawara), fortification line, ruins, distant view. © Photograph Josephine Powell c. 1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

According to the drawings of the surviving structures made by Herberg and Ball, there is a remarkable variation in ground plans.[41] As noted above, the towers were circular or angular on plan, and either independent or addorsed to larger enclosures or buildings. The larger complexes exhibited the greatest variety of plans among themselves, ranging from rectangular enclosures to cruciform structures (e.g. Figure 2.10), with some combining these forms in more complex layouts. While a more systematic survey and certainly archaeological excavation could both aid in determining at least a relative chronology or developmental sequence among these plans, at present the documentation stands as it is, lacking the evidence for larger patterns of change over time.

Overall, southern–central Ghur's surviving structures seem recalcitrantly resistant to dating, both in terms of period of construction and longevity of use. No epigraphic data have been recovered, so there are no known foundation dates, patrons, or builders as points of departure